

Self-pin as black defence

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Pins are deadly weapons in chess armoury. In games we come across chessmen which either pin or get pinned. It can be an 'absolute pin' when the king is involved or 'relative pin' where the removal of the pinned piece leads to capture of the rear piece of higher value. In problem chess paradoxically an apparently suicidal 'self-pin' is used as black defence. A few of the different motives for such self-pins could be i) to capture the mate threatening white piece ii) to remove the white guard in BK's field to set up potential escape squares iii) to get pinned to get unpinned later by the threat. Special types of self-pins like Nietvelt and Schiffmann fall under this category. Ultimately these self-pins lead to attractive pin mates which constitute the crux of the problem.

S.C.Dutt

The Hindu 1955



Mate in two moves

In the problem above there are seven arrival self-pins, three on c7 which remove the mate threatening white rook and four on e6 which remove the additional guard of d7, leading to pin mates. The key is **1.fxe5!** (2.Rc6) with following variations: 1...Rxc7 2.Nb7; 1...Bxc7 2.Rb6; 1...Nxc7 2.e8N; 1...Bxe6 2.Nf7; 1...Nxe6

2.Rd3; 1...Rxe6 2.Ne4 and 1...Qxe6 2.Nf5.

In the second example self pins are created by moving the black king into the pin. Here the BQ gets pinned four times. After key **1.Qd8!** threatening (2.Qxd4) the variations are 1...Kd2 2.Nc4; 1...Ke4 2.Ng6; 1...Kf4 2.Nd3; 1.Kf2 2.Nxg4; 1...Qxa7 2.Ng2

G.Cristofannini

I prize, Grantham Journal 1931



Mate in two moves

In the problem given below for solving after the check provoking key there are three self-pins, two on b6 and the third on c3.

G.Dobbs

Good Companions 1919



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'The white battery':

Set: 1...Rc3+ 2.2.Rc5; 1...Rf7+ 2.Rd7; 1...Be5+ 2.Rd6 **Key 1.Kxb6!** (2.Nc5) 1...Rb3+ 2.Rb5; 1...Rf6+ 2.Rd6; 1...Bd4+ 2.Rc5

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